

Optimizing Predictive Maintenance of CNC Machines Using Modified Ensemble Learning and Feature Engineering: A Data-Driven Case Study

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Abstract

Industry 4.0 technologies have transformed predictive maintenance (PdM) through IoT sensors, big data analytics, and machine learning (ML). Despite recent advances, ensemble-based approaches remain largely underexplored for CNC machine maintenance in manufacturing. This study develops a modified ensemble method combining five ML algorithms—Support Vector Machine, Random Forest, K-Nearest Neighbors, Logistic Regression, and Gradient Boosting Classifier—with engineered features derived from 10,000 multivariate time-series observations. Four relationship-based features (Relation Temperature, Power, WearRPM, ToolWearTorque) were constructed from sensor data to capture thermal stress, energy consumption, and tool degradation patterns. The modified ensemble achieved 99.16% accuracy by classifying failure when any constituent model detected anomalies, reducing false negatives from 55.4% to 12% compared to traditional voting methods. Furthermore, a two-stage alert system was implemented: stage one detects 99.5% of non-failure cases through ensemble prediction, while stage two applies threshold analysis to operational parameters. Field deployment showed 88% of failures occurred between alerts, enabling preemptive shutdowns. This architecture reduces maintenance costs and unplanned downtime while extending equipment lifespan in electrode manufacturing operations.

Keywords: Predictive analytics, Predictive maintenance, Machine learning, Ensemble learning, Smart manufacturing, Computational engineering, Machine breakdown, Delay-time

1. Introduction

Predictive Maintenance (PdM) is a proactive maintenance strategy that utilizes sensor data and real-time information from industrial equipment to predict potential failures before they occur, thereby enabling timely and condition-based maintenance interventions. In the context of Industry 4.0, PdM plays a critical role in smart manufacturing environments and IoT-enabled systems by supporting data-driven decision-making, minimizing unplanned downtime, reducing operational costs, and enhancing overall productivity. With the recent evolution toward Industry 5.0, it has gained greater significance by fostering human-machine collaboration, allowing workers to concentrate on higher-level cognitive and creative tasks while ensuring the continuous reliability of industrial assets. PdM serves as a foundational technology that ensures operational continuity and facilitates the transition

from fully automated manufacturing systems toward more human-centered, adaptive, and resilient industrial environments. It also contributes to sustainability by reducing energy consumption, minimizing material waste, and supporting the efficient production of high-quality, customized goods. The concept of PdM dates back to the 1940s, when C.H. Waddington introduced a data-informed maintenance strategy for the British Air Force by questioning the fixed policy of servicing fighter aircraft every 50 flying hours [1, 2]. His findings demonstrated that nearly 60% of maintenance activities could be optimized. However, despite its potential, PdM received limited attention for several decades. The absence of real-time data acquisition and processing capabilities constrained further methodological development until the late 20th century [3], leaving PdM largely reliant on heuristic and experience-based practices [4].

The emergence of the Fourth Industrial Revolution marked a turning point for PdM implementation. Industry 4.0 technologies, including smart automation systems, machine learning (ML), artificial intelligence (AI), big data analytics, Internet of Things (IoT), and advanced sensing infrastructure, have enabled continuous condition monitoring and data-driven decision-making in manufacturing environments [5, 6]. These advancements have trans-

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formed PdM from a conceptual framework into a practical and scalable industrial solution.

Within this context, feature engineering has become a critical component of PdM model development, as predictive performance is strongly influenced by the quality and relevance of extracted features [7]. Furthermore, automated data collection from industrial equipment has facilitated the deployment of ML-based fault detection and diagnosis systems [8]. Nevertheless, the effectiveness of PdM solutions remains highly dependent on appropriate choices of learning algorithms, data representations, data volumes, and machine configurations. Inadequate selections can lead to unreliable predictions and suboptimal maintenance planning [9]. This case study will try to align ML algorithms, advanced feature engineering, data-driven failure characterization, and operational threshold analysis along with a modified ensemble learning strategy tailored for CNC machine maintenance for improving failure detection reliability and reducing false negative rates.

1.1. Background and Motivation

Industry 4.0 integrates digital and physical technologies into manufacturing systems through the Industrial Internet of Things (IIoT), enabling real-time data acquisition from temperature, motion, camera, and GPS sensors [5, 10, 11, 12]. This integration supports cloud-based analytics and data-driven decision-making, fundamentally reshaping maintenance strategies in modern factories. Predictive Maintenance (PdM) leverages these capabilities to forecast equipment failures before their occurrence [13], and has been adopted by major industrial organizations such as GE, Honeywell, Intel, Siemens, Tesla, IBM, and Martin Lockheed [14, 15] to reduce unplanned downtime and operational costs.

In electrode manufacturing, computer numerical control (CNC) machines are used to produce high-precision components from graphite, copper, tungsten, and other conductive materials [16, 17]. These electrodes are essential for applications in the automotive, aerospace, medical, and electronics industries, where dimensional accuracy and process reliability are critical [18, 10]. The high operational loads and continuous usage of CNC machines make them particularly susceptible to tool wear, thermal stress, and mechanical degradation, increasing the importance of reliable PdM systems.

Machine learning has significantly enhanced PdM capabilities since the early 2000s, with broader adoption following the maturation of IoT and big data infrastructures between 2010 and 2014 [19]. Standard PdM pipelines include sensor data acquisition, preprocessing, feature extraction, dimensionality reduction, and model development. Continuous machine health monitoring tracks parameters such as tool wear, torque, and vibration to detect degradation trends [20, 21, 22]. These approaches have been shown to reduce maintenance costs, extend equipment operating time by 10% to 20%, and shorten maintenance scheduling cycles [23].

To improve predictive performance, ensemble learning algorithms (ELA) have been increasingly adopted in ML-based PdM systems, achieving classification accuracies above 96% in manufacturing environments [24] and over 98% in textile applications [25]. However, most existing ensemble methods rely on symmetric aggregation strategies that prioritize overall accuracy rather than the asymmetric risk structure of industrial maintenance. In CNC operations, false negatives are significantly more costly than false positives, as undetected failures can lead to severe equipment damage, production interruptions, and safety risks. Despite this, ensemble-based PdM approaches for CNC machines remain limited, and optimal base learner configurations are not well established. These limitations motivate the development of a modified ensemble learning framework that emphasizes failure detection sensitivity in CNC maintenance applications.

1.2. Problem Assessment

Traditional PdM approaches often struggle to capture the complex and nonlinear relationships associated with CNC machine health, which can lead to suboptimal maintenance planning and scheduling. Additionally, conventional feature extraction techniques may be insufficient in uncovering hidden dependencies within high-dimensional industrial datasets. These limitations highlight a critical need for customized PdM solutions that effectively integrate ensemble learning strategies with advanced feature engineering techniques. Addressing this gap is essential for maximizing equipment uptime, minimizing unplanned downtime, and optimizing the overall operational efficiency of CNC machines. This study aims to overcome these challenges through the proposed ML-based PdM framework.

1.3. Research Objectives

The primary objective of this research is to develop an advanced predictive maintenance model for CNC machines in the manufacturing industry using ensemble learning-based ML techniques. The specific objectives of the study are as follows:

- To investigate the integration of ensemble learning algorithms for predictive maintenance of CNC machines and assess their effectiveness within manufacturing environments.
- To evaluate the impact of ensemble learning-based feature engineering on improving predictive accuracy and precision compared to conventional ML-driven PdM approaches.
- To develop a comprehensive PdM model capable of predicting machine health status and failure conditions, thereby supporting downtime reduction and maximizing operational performance.

1.4. Research Contribution

This study contributes to predictive maintenance research by proposing a modified ensemble learning framework tailored for CNC machine health monitoring in manufacturing environments. From a methodological perspective, the research introduces an ensemble strategy that prioritizes failure detection sensitivity in line with the asymmetric risk characteristics of industrial maintenance. From a modeling perspective, it demonstrates the role of domain-informed feature engineering in enhancing the effectiveness of ensemble-based PdM systems. Empirically, the study provides a validated case study using real manufacturing data, illustrating how the proposed framework can support practical maintenance decision-making and improve operational reliability. Together, these contributions bridge the gap between theoretical machine learning methods and deployable predictive maintenance solutions for Industry 4.0-enabled manufacturing systems.

2. Literature Review

Industry 4.0 has accelerated the digital transformation of manufacturing by integrating automation, data analytics, and intelligent maintenance systems. While earlier industrial revolutions established large-scale mechanized production ([26]), many facilities still rely on manual or spreadsheet-based maintenance practices. In contrast, organizations such as Intel Corporation ([27], Toyota [28], Lockheed Martin [29, 30], Tesla [31], Mercedes-Benz Group [32, 33], and Rockwell Automation [34, 35] have adopted ML-driven predictive maintenance (PdM) solutions. However, many deployed models remain structurally conventional, motivating the need for more adaptive and automated PdM frameworks [36].

Beyond Industry 4.0 environments, [37] demonstrated the effectiveness of ML-based PdM in Industry 3.0 systems using an adaptive ARIMA model for sand molding machines, achieving substantial reductions in failures and improvements in mean time between failures. These results highlight the potential of data-driven maintenance while emphasizing the need for continuous optimization for scalable industrial deployment.

Contemporary PdM systems integrate real-time sensor data, historical records, and ML models to identify degradation patterns and predict failures [38]. IoT-enabled data acquisition supports early fault detection and diagnosis across industrial equipment [4]. Shamayleh et al. [39, 40] emphasized the role of ML-based PdM frameworks with economic feasibility considerations, while Li et al. [41] demonstrated that integrating PdM with production planning and quality control reduces maintenance costs without compromising efficiency.

2.1. Traditional Approaches for Predictive Maintenance of CNC Machines

Traditional predictive maintenance (PdM) for CNC machines has mainly relied on condition-based monitoring

and reliability-driven models using predefined thresholds and statistical degradation assumptions [42, 43]. Early methods tracked signals such as vibration, spindle temperature, cutting forces, acoustic emissions, and tool wear, initiating maintenance once empirically defined limits were exceeded [44]. While interpretable and computationally efficient, these techniques are mostly effective at detecting late-stage degradation and offer limited capability for early fault prediction in complex machining environments [45].

Reliability-oriented models, including Weibull-based failure analysis [46], proportional hazards models [47], and time-based remaining useful life (RUL) estimation [48], provide long-term maintenance insights but assume stationary operating conditions and require extensive historical failure data. In modern CNC systems with variable loads, materials, and cutting parameters, such assumptions often result in delayed fault detection or overly conservative maintenance schedules [49, 50]. Overall, these limitations have driven the shift toward data-driven and ensemble-based learning approaches that better capture nonlinear interactions [51, 52] and improve sensitivity to rare but critical failures [24, 53].

2.2. Machine Learning-Based Approaches for Predictive Maintenance

Machine learning (ML) has become a cornerstone of modern predictive maintenance (PdM), enabling anomaly detection, failure prediction, and maintenance optimization from sensor data. Conventional ML-based PdM frameworks follow structured pipelines, including data acquisition, preprocessing, feature extraction, dimensionality reduction, and model development [20, 54]. ML-driven PdM has been applied across diverse manufacturing domains, supporting smart and sustainable operations by leveraging advances in algorithms, data acquisition, and industrial classification techniques [55]. A structured summary of key ML-based PdM research across multiple industries is presented in Table 1.

Supervised ML approaches demonstrate strong predictive performance when labeled data are available, while unsupervised methods identify anomalies and patterns in high-dimensional sensor streams when failure labels are scarce. Algorithms such as support vector machines, k-nearest neighbors, random forest, gradient boosting classifiers, logistic regression, and artificial neural networks have been successfully applied to CNC, automotive, textile, and printing machine maintenance, highlighting the flexibility and adaptability of ML for early fault detection [56, 57]. These methods form the foundation for more advanced ensemble-based PdM strategies that combine multiple learners to enhance accuracy, robustness, and sensitivity to rare but critical failures in manufacturing environments [58, 59, 60].

A structured summary of key ML-based PdM research across multiple industries is presented in Table 1.

Table 1: Summary of Key Literature on Predictive Maintenance, Machine Learning, and Industrial Applications

Reference	Topic	Author(s)	Title / Focus
Maintenance	Modelling	Zhu et al. (2024) [61]	Predictive maintenance frameworks
Maintenance	Modelling	Serradilla et al. (2022) [62]	DL architectures for PdM, applications, and industrial integration challenges
Maintenance	Modelling	Florian et al. (2021) [63]	Cost-oriented ML-based PdM model with decision support systems
Maintenance	Modelling	Nowakowski et al. (2019) [64]	Brief survey of predictive maintenance
Maintenance	Modelling	Peng et al. (2010) [65]	Prognostics in condition-based maintenance
PdM & ML		L Chen et al. (2020) [66]	ML in machine fault diagnosis
PdM & ML		Fink et al. (2020) [67]	Deep learning in prognostics and health management
PdM & ML		H Liu et al. (2021) [68]	DL for machine health monitoring
PdM & ML		Carvalho et al. (2019) [69]	ML for predictive maintenance
PdM & ML		Khan & Yairi (2017) [5]	Deep learning in system health management
PdM & ML		Tsui et al. (2015) [70]	Data-driven approaches in PHM
PdM & ML		Schwabacher & Goebel (2007) [71]	AI in prognostics
Data-based & PdM	Models	Meriem et al. (2023) [72]	Data-driven PdM using Industry 4.0 technologies
Data-based & PdM	Models	Fordal et al. (2023) [73]	ANN and sensor-based PdM platform for Industry 4.0
Data-based & PdM	Models	Khan et al. (2023) [74]	ML/DL-based modeling for traffic congestion
Data-based & PdM	Models	Patil et al. (2023) [75]	Data-driven PdM methods focusing on ML/DL and industrial automotive tools
Automotive & ML		Mahliyo et al. (2025) [76]	ML based conditional monitoring
Automotive & ML		Jain et al. (2022) [77]	ML techniques for PdM and vehicle health diagnosis
Automotive & ML		Chen et al. (2020) [78]	Review of statistical, and stochastic approaches for automotive PdM
Automotive & ML		Yildirim et al. (2025) [79]	AI for data analysis, PdM, and performance optimization

2.3. Ensemble Learning in Predictive Maintenance

Ensemble learning has become a robust approach in predictive maintenance (PdM) by combining multiple base learners to improve prediction accuracy, stability, and adaptability in noisy, incomplete, or imbalanced industrial datasets. Adaptive frameworks, such as Hung [24], employ error-feedback mechanisms that recalibrate predictions at the output layer, dynamically adjusting ensemble components for changing operating conditions. By leveraging complementary strengths of individual models, ensemble methods reduce bias and variance, providing more reliable estimates of machine health and remaining useful life (RUL) [80].

A growing body of empirical research demonstrates the superiority of ensemble methods over classical and deep learning models in industrial contexts. Deshpande et al. [81] developed a hybrid ensemble combining time series forests, catch22, and ARSENAL classifiers, achieving earlier fault detection compared to LSTMs. In semiconduc-

tor manufacturing, Butte et al. [82] identified ensembles as more effective than generalized linear models, random forests, gradient boosting machines, and deep learning architectures. Similarly, Cárdenas-Gallo et al. [83] and Zhao [84] reported ensemble-based models outperforming support vector machines, gamma process models, and neural networks in real-time industrial and turbofan engine datasets.

These studies collectively underscore the suitability of ensemble learning for complex, data-intensive manufacturing systems, including CNC machining operations. By combining diverse models and incorporating adaptive learning, ensemble-based PdM frameworks can enhance early failure detection, improve operational reliability, and better handle rare but critical failure events. Such capabilities align closely with the objectives of this study, which seeks to develop a modified ensemble approach tailored to CNC machine health monitoring and predictive maintenance.

2.4. Research Gaps and Motivation

Despite significant advancements in predictive maintenance through machine learning, several critical research gaps remain. From a methodological perspective, the majority of existing studies rely on single-model approaches, while ensemble learning frameworks remain comparatively underexplored. Empirically, many PdM models are validated primarily on benchmark or synthetic datasets, limiting their generalizability and transferability to real-world industrial environments.

A theoretical gap is also evident, as current literature often lacks a rigorous conceptual justification for why ensemble learning should outperform traditional ML models in complex manufacturing systems. Furthermore, a notable data gap exists in CNC-based manufacturing, where high-quality, domain-specific datasets are scarce. From a practical standpoint, limited attention has been given to scalability, robustness, and interpretability—factors that are essential for successful industrial adoption of PdM solutions.

By addressing these gaps, the present study seeks to advance predictive maintenance research through a focused application of ensemble learning, empirical validation using established benchmarks, and consideration of practical deployment challenges in manufacturing environments.

3. Methodology

The development and application of predictive maintenance classifiers involve a structured workflow consisting of data selection and processing, machine learning model implementation, and performance evaluation. In this study, several supervised machine learning classifiers are employed, including SVM, RF, KNN, LR, and GBC. The methodological framework incorporates feature engineering techniques to enhance data representation, followed by the application of both traditional ensemble methods and a modified ensemble learning strategy. This comprehensive methodology enables systematic comparison between standalone machine learning models and ensemble-based predictive maintenance approaches.

3.1. Overview and Workflow

Figure 1 presents the overall workflow of the proposed PdM framework, outlining a structured progression from data acquisition to final model deployment. The process begins with dataset selection and exploratory data analysis to understand feature distributions and failure characteristics. Based on these insights, suitable machine learning models are selected, followed by parallel workflows involving conventional feature-based modeling and physics-informed feature engineering.

As shown in Figure 1, both workflows undergo independent model training and hyperparameter tuning, after which their results are analyzed and compared. The

framework then evaluates two ensemble strategies: a conventional majority voting ensemble and a customized OR-logic ensemble designed to enhance failure detection. Comparative analysis of these approaches guides final model selection, prioritizing high failure sensitivity while maintaining operational feasibility. This systematic workflow enables rigorous evaluation of individual models, engineered features, and ensemble strategies against conventional predictive maintenance approaches.

3.2. Data Preprocessing Pipeline

As shown in the workflow and exemplified in Table 2, the AI4I 2020 Predictive Maintenance dataset comprising 10,000 instances forms the basis of model development. It includes five key operational variables—air temperature [K], process temperature [K], rotational speed [rpm], torque [Nm], and tool wear [min]—with machine failure labeled as 1 and normal operation as 0. The dataset is highly imbalanced, with only 339 failure instances (3.39%).

Preprocessing involves data loading and exploratory analysis to assess feature distributions. Air temperature centers around 300 K, process temperature around 310 K, and tool wear exhibits a skewed distribution, while other features are approximately normal. The dataset is partitioned into training (75%) and testing (25%) sets using stratified sampling to preserve failure class proportions and ensure unbiased evaluation.

3.3. Feature Engineering Approach

Feature engineering plays a pivotal role in transforming raw sensor data into meaningful predictors that enhance model accuracy and interpretability. Based on correlation analysis and domain expertise in CNC thermomechanical behavior, four relationship-based features were constructed from sensor data to capture thermal stress, energy consumption, and tool degradation patterns. The correlation matrix analysis revealed that air temperature and process temperature exhibit strong positive correlation (0.86), while rotational speed and torque show strong negative correlation (-0.86). These observations motivated the derivation of physics-informed features. The engineered features are defined as follows:

$$\text{RelationTemperature} = \frac{\text{Air temperature [K]} - \text{Process temperature [K]}}{2} \quad (1)$$

$$\text{Power [W]} = \frac{\text{Torque [Nm]} \times \text{Rotational speed [rpm]}}{9.5488} \quad (2)$$

$$\text{WearRPM} = \frac{\text{Tool wear [min]}}{\text{Rotational speed [rpm]}} \quad (3)$$

$$\text{ToolWearTorque} = \frac{\text{Tool wear [min]}}{\text{Torque [Nm]}} \quad (4)$$

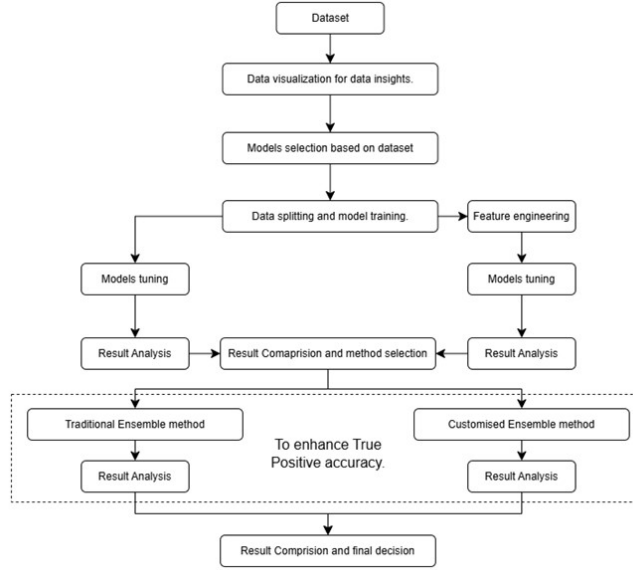


Figure 1: The workflow diagram of the research methodology.

Table 2: Sample dataset with the new derived features

Product ID	Type	Air temp [K]	Process temp [K]	RPM	Torque [Nm]	Tool wear [min]	Failure	RelationTemp	Power (W)	WearRPM	ToolWearTorque
M14860	M	298.1	308.6	1551	42.8	0	0	-10.5	6951.952	0	0
L47181	L	298.2	308.7	1408	46.3	3	0	-10.5	6827.078	0.002131	0.064795
L47182	L	298.1	308.5	1498	49.4	5	0	-10.4	7749.791	0.003338	0.101215
L47183	L	298.2	308.6	1433	39.5	7	0	-10.4	5927.813	0.004885	0.177215
L47184	L	298.2	308.7	1408	40.0	9	0	-10.5	5898.123	0.006392	0.225000
M14865	M	298.1	308.6	1425	41.9	11	0	-10.5	6252.880	0.007719	0.262530
L47186	L	298.1	308.6	1558	42.4	14	0	-10.5	6918.063	0.008986	0.330189
L47187	L	298.1	308.6	1527	40.2	16	0	-10.5	6428.598	0.010478	0.398010
M14868	M	298.3	308.7	1667	28.6	18	0	-10.4	4992.900	0.010798	0.629371
M14869	M	298.5	309.0	1741	28.0	21	0	-10.5	5105.144	0.012062	0.750000

Relation Temperature captures the thermal stress gradient between ambient air and process temperature, indicating cooling system efficacy and thermal strain on machine components. Analysis revealed that failures occur more frequently when this difference falls outside the range of -12.1 K to -7.6 K. Power represents energy consumption dynamics, derived from torque and rotational speed, capturing mechanical load patterns. Machines operating within 3515.22 W to 8998.49 W showed significantly lower failure rates. WearRPM quantifies tool degradation velocity by normalizing tool wear against rotational speed, with values below 0.174 indicating optimal operational conditions. ToolWearTorque measures tool loading ratio, with threshold values below 0.26253 minimizing machine failure probability. These engineered features enable earlier identification of degradation patterns compared to raw sensor inputs alone.

3.4. Base Classifiers

Five supervised machine learning algorithms serve as base classifiers in the proposed ensemble framework. Each algorithm was selected based on its proven effectiveness in predictive maintenance applications and complementary learning characteristics.

3.4.1. Support Vector Machine (SVM)

Support Vector Machine constructs optimal hyperplanes in high-dimensional feature space to separate failure and non-failure classes. The algorithm seeks to maximize the margin between classes while minimizing classification error. For a binary classification problem with training data $\{(x_i, y_i)\}$ where $x_i \in \mathbb{R}^n$ and $y_i \in \{-1, 1\}$, the SVM optimization problem is formulated as:

$$\min_{w,b} \frac{1}{2} \|w\|^2 + C \sum_{i=1}^n \xi_i \quad (5)$$

subject to $y_i(w^T x_i + b) \geq 1 - \xi_i$ and $\xi_i \geq 0$, where w is the weight vector, b is the bias term, C is the regularization parameter, and ξ_i are slack variables. The kernel trick enables SVM to handle non-linearly separable data by mapping inputs to higher-dimensional spaces. In this study, SVM achieved 97% accuracy on the test set.

3.4.2. Random Forest Classifier (RFC)

Random Forest is an ensemble learning method that constructs multiple decision trees during training and outputs the mode of class predictions. Each tree is trained on a bootstrap sample of the training data, and at each node split, a random subset of features is considered. For

a forest of T trees, the final prediction is:

$$\hat{y} = \text{mode}\{h_1(x), h_2(x), \dots, h_T(x)\} \quad (6)$$

where $h_t(x)$ represents the prediction of the t -th tree. Random Forest reduces overfitting through bagging and feature randomization, providing robust predictions even with noisy data. The algorithm uses numerous decision trees to avoid overfitting and noise, resulting in robust and effective outlier handling. RFC achieved 98.92% accuracy, with a true positive rate of 83.1%, successfully detecting 69 failures while missing 14.

3.4.3. K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN)

K-Nearest Neighbors is a non-parametric algorithm that classifies instances based on the majority class among their k nearest neighbors in feature space. The distance metric, typically Euclidean distance, is defined as:

$$d(x_i, x_j) = \sqrt{\sum_{m=1}^n (x_{im} - x_{jm})^2} \quad (7)$$

The prediction for a test instance x is determined by:

$$\hat{y} = \text{mode}\{y_{i_1}, y_{i_2}, \dots, y_{i_k}\} \quad (8)$$

where $\{i_1, i_2, \dots, i_k\}$ are the indices of the k nearest neighbors. KNN's simplicity and effectiveness make it suitable for local pattern recognition. However, in this study, KNN identified only 31 failures (37.3%) while missing 52, achieving 97.28% overall accuracy but demonstrating limited sensitivity to failure events.

3.4.4. Logistic Regression (LR)

Logistic Regression models the probability of binary outcomes using the logistic function. For input features x , the probability of failure is computed as:

$$P(y = 1|x) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-(w^T x + b)}} \quad (9)$$

where w represents feature weights and b is the bias term. The model parameters are learned by minimizing the log-loss function:

$$L(w, b) = - \sum_{i=1}^n [y_i \log(\hat{y}_i) + (1 - y_i) \log(1 - \hat{y}_i)] \quad (10)$$

Logistic Regression provides interpretable coefficients indicating feature importance. In this study, LR detected only 21 failures (25.3%) while misclassifying 62, achieving 97.32% accuracy but exhibiting high false negative rates.

3.4.5. Gradient Boosting Classifier (GBC)

Gradient Boosting constructs an ensemble of weak learners, typically decision trees, in a sequential manner where each subsequent model corrects errors made by previous

models. The algorithm minimizes a loss function through gradient descent in function space:

$$F_m(x) = F_{m-1}(x) + \gamma_m h_m(x) \quad (11)$$

where $F_m(x)$ is the ensemble prediction after m iterations, $h_m(x)$ is the m -th weak learner, and γ_m is the learning rate. The weak learner $h_m(x)$ is trained to predict the negative gradient of the loss function. Gradient Boosting enhances accuracy by progressively creating trees and iteratively correcting errors, particularly for difficult-to-predict situations. GBC achieved 98.96% accuracy with 75.9% true positive rate, correctly identifying 63 failures while misclassifying 20, demonstrating strong performance in failure detection.

3.5. Proposed Ensemble Architecture

The proposed ensemble framework addresses the critical limitation of traditional voting-based ensembles: their inability to prioritize failure detection sensitivity in highly imbalanced datasets. Traditional ensemble methods employ majority voting, where the final prediction is determined by the mode of individual model predictions. However, this symmetric aggregation treats false negatives (missed failures) and false positives (unnecessary inspections) as equally undesirable, failing to encode the asymmetric cost structure inherent to industrial maintenance operations.

3.5.1. Ensemble Strategy and Design

In CNC manufacturing environments, the cost of a false negative—resulting in undetected equipment failure, catastrophic damage, production line shutdown, and potential safety hazards—vastly exceeds the cost of a false positive, which merely triggers an unnecessary inspection. This asymmetry necessitates a classification strategy that explicitly prioritizes recall (sensitivity) over aggregate accuracy. The proposed modified ensemble method employs OR-logic classification: a machine failure is predicted if **any** constituent model detects anomalous behavior, rather than requiring consensus among models.

3.5.2. Mathematical Formulation

Let $f_{\text{SVM}}(x)$, $f_{\text{RF}}(x)$, $f_{\text{KNN}}(x)$, $f_{\text{LR}}(x)$, and $f_{\text{GBC}}(x)$ denote the binary predictions of the five base classifiers for input x , where each $f_i(x) \in \{0, 1\}$ indicates non-failure (0) or failure (1).

Traditional Voting Ensemble:

$$\hat{y}_{\text{voting}}(x) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } \sum_i f_i(x) \geq k \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \quad (12)$$

where k is the voting threshold, typically set to $\lceil N/2 \rceil$ for majority voting with $N = 5$ models.

Modified OR-Logic Ensemble:

$$\hat{y}_{\text{ensemble}}(x) = \max\{f_{\text{SVM}}(x), f_{\text{RF}}(x), f_{\text{KNN}}(x), f_{\text{LR}}(x), f_{\text{GBC}}(x)\} \quad (13)$$

Equivalently:

$$\hat{y}_{\text{ensemble}}(x) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if any } f_i(x) = 1 \\ 0 & \text{if all } f_i(x) = 0 \end{cases} \quad (14)$$

This formulation ensures that failure is predicted whenever at least one base classifier detects anomalous behavior, maximizing sensitivity at the potential cost of increased false positives. The rationale is that in predictive maintenance applications, it is preferable to investigate a potential failure that turns out to be benign rather than miss an actual failure that could lead to catastrophic consequences.

3.5.3. Ensemble Algorithm

The implementation of the modified ensemble method follows this procedure:

1. Train each base classifier (f_{SVM} , f_{RF} , f_{KNN} , f_{LR} , f_{GBC}) independently on the training dataset containing both original and engineered features.
2. For each test instance x , obtain binary predictions from all five classifiers.
3. Apply OR-logic aggregation: if any classifier predicts failure ($f_i(x) = 1$), classify the instance as failure; otherwise, classify as non-failure.
4. Evaluate ensemble performance using metrics appropriate for imbalanced classification: accuracy, precision, recall (true positive rate), specificity (true negative rate), F1-score, and Matthews Correlation Coefficient ([85]).

The traditional voting classifier is also implemented for comparison, where failure is predicted only if the majority of classifiers (at least 3 out of 5) predict failure.

3.5.4. Architecture Diagram

The ensemble architecture integrates multiple base learners through parallel prediction pathways. Each classifier processes the same input features independently, generating binary predictions based on its learned decision boundary. The traditional voting ensemble aggregates these predictions through majority voting, while the modified ensemble employs OR-logic to maximize failure detection sensitivity. This dual evaluation enables direct comparison of symmetric versus asymmetric ensemble strategies.

The modified ensemble achieved 99.16% overall accuracy while reducing false negatives from 55.4% (traditional voting) to 12%, correctly identifying 88% of failure events. This represents a 78% reduction in missed failures compared to traditional voting methods, while maintaining 99.5% specificity in non-failure case identification. The ensemble’s performance demonstrates that explicitly encoding operational cost asymmetry into the classification logic

yields substantial improvements in failure detection sensitivity, the primary objective of predictive maintenance systems.

4. Experimental Setup

This section outlines the experimental framework adopted in this study, including the dataset characteristics, feature engineering procedures, hyperparameter settings, evaluation metrics, and computational environment. The design of the experimental setup emphasizes reproducibility and objective assessment of the proposed ensemble-based predictive maintenance framework.

4.1. Dataset Description

The AI4I 2020 Predictive Maintenance dataset [86] from the UCI Machine Learning Repository is used as the primary benchmark for experimental evaluation. It contains 10,000 instances with five operational variables—air temperature, process temperature, rotational speed, torque, and tool wear—along with a binary machine failure label. Although synthetically generated, the dataset models realistic CNC operating conditions, capturing thermal behavior, mechanical loading, and tool degradation patterns. Its structured multivariate representation makes it suitable for comparative evaluation of data-driven PdM models.

Table 3 summarizes the dataset statistics. Operating parameters exhibit realistic ranges consistent with CNC environments, while failure events account for only 3.39% of samples, reflecting real-world class imbalance. This poses a challenge for predictive models that must balance early fault detection with false alarm control.

Exploratory data analysis highlights distribution and correlation patterns ([87]). Figure 2 shows the distributions of operational parameters: all but tool wear are approximately normal, supporting reliable model training. Correlation analysis reveals that air temperature and process temperature are strongly positively correlated (0.86), while rotational speed and torque are strongly negatively correlated (-0.86). These insights inform the feature engineering strategy, identifying derived features that capture physically meaningful relationships in CNC operations.

4.2. Hyperparameter Configuration

Hyperparameter selection is critical for balancing predictive accuracy, robustness, and computational efficiency. All models were configured using empirically validated settings commonly adopted in predictive maintenance studies, with explicit consideration of nonlinearity and severe class imbalance.

Support Vector Machines (SVM) employed a radial basis function (RBF) kernel with $C = 1.0$ and kernel width determined by the *scale* heuristic, $\gamma = \frac{1}{n_{\text{features}} \text{Var}(X)}$, while balanced class weights were applied to mitigate skewed failure distributions. Random Forest Classifiers (RFC)

Table 3: Statistical summary of the AI4I 2020 Predictive Maintenance dataset

Metric	Count	Mean	Std	Min	25%	50%	75%	Max
UDI	10000	5000.5	2886.9	1	2500.8	5000.5	7500.3	10000
Air temp. [K]	10000	300.0	2.0	294	298.3	300.1	301.5	304.9
Proc. temp. [K]	10000	310.0	1.5	305.7	308.8	310.1	311.1	315.2
Rot. speed [rpm]	10000	1539.4	182.1	1150	1423	1503	1612	2886
Torque [Nm]	10000	40.0	10.0	3.8	33.2	40.1	46.8	76.6
Tool wear [min]	10000	108.0	63.7	0	53	108	162	253
Machine failure	10000	0.034	0.181	0	0	0	0	1

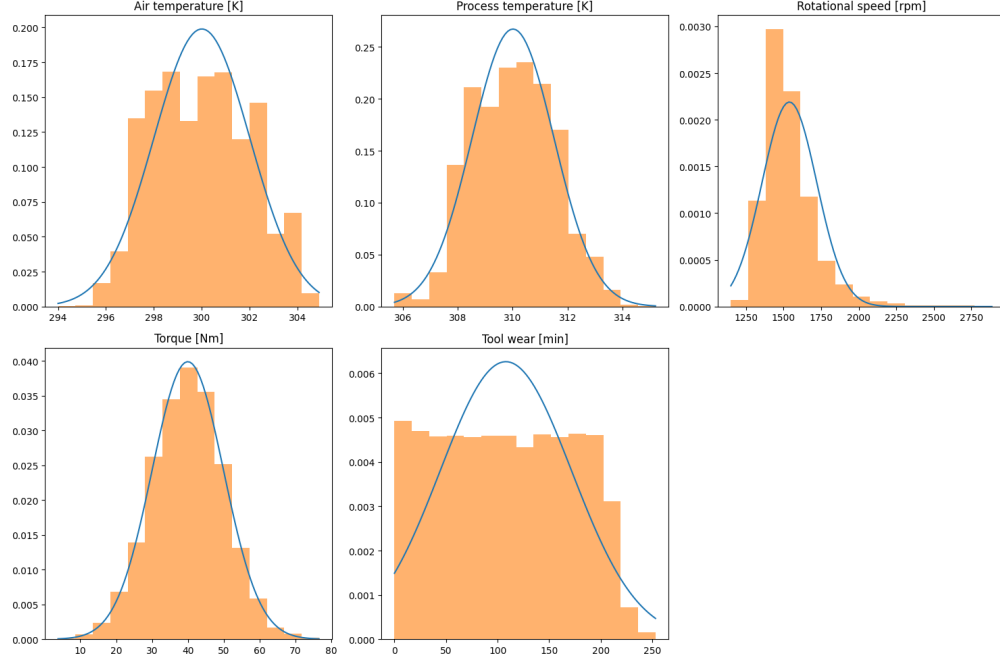


Figure 2: Normal distribution curves of air temperature, process temperature, rotational speed, torque, and tool wear

were configured with 100 trees using bootstrap aggregation and feature subsampling ($\sqrt{n_{\text{features}}}$) at each split, allowing unrestricted tree depth and minimal node-splitting constraints to promote ensemble diversity. Logistic Regression (LR) utilized L2 regularization with $C = 1.0$, optimized via the *lbfgs* solver with a maximum of 1000 iterations, and incorporated balanced class weighting. K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN) was configured with $k = 5$ using Euclidean distance and uniform neighbor weighting, with automatic selection of the most efficient search algorithm. Gradient Boosting Machines (GBM) employed 100 boosting iterations with a learning rate of $\eta = 0.1$, tree depth limited to 3, and log-loss as the objective function to control overfitting.

The proposed ensemble framework integrates these base learners using two aggregation strategies. A traditional hard-voting ensemble assigns equal weights to all classifiers and predicts failure when at least three out of five models agree. In contrast, the modified OR-logic ensemble predicts failure if any single base classifier detects an anomaly, effectively lowering the decision threshold to $k = 1$ and prioritizing recall over precision to enhance early fault de-

tection.

4.3. Evaluation Metrics

Comprehensive evaluation requires multiple metrics, particularly for imbalanced classification problems where accuracy alone can be misleading. The confusion matrix forms the foundation for all metrics, defined as:

Based on the confusion matrix presented above, multiple evaluation metrics were used to assess model performance, particularly under imbalanced classification settings where accuracy alone can be misleading. Accuracy indicates the proportion of correctly classified instances but does not reflect error asymmetry in failure prediction. Precision measures the reliability of positive predictions, while recall (sensitivity) evaluates the model’s ability to correctly identify actual failure events. The F1-score, as the harmonic mean of precision and recall, provides a balanced assessment when both false positives and false negatives are consequential. Specificity quantifies the correct identification of non-failure cases, helping to reduce unnecessary maintenance actions. The false negative rate was given special attention due to its direct impact on unplanned downtime

		Predicted Class	
		Negative (0)	Positive (1)
Actual Class	Negative (0)	True Negative (TN)	False Positive (FP)
	Positive (1)	False Negative (FN)	True Positive (TP)

and equipment failure. Collectively, these metrics offer a comprehensive evaluation framework that balances detection effectiveness with operational reliability.

4.4. Experimental Environment

All experiments were conducted under a controlled and reproducible computational environment to ensure fair model comparison. The experimental platform consisted of a multi-threaded Intel Core i7 (or equivalent) processor with 16 GB DDR4 RAM, 512 GB SSD storage, and either Windows 10 or Ubuntu 20.04 LTS as the operating system. The predictive maintenance framework was implemented in Python 3.8+, utilizing NumPy (v1.21+) and Pandas (v1.3+) for numerical computation and data handling, Scikit-learn (v1.0+) for model implementation and evaluation, and Matplotlib (v3.4+) and Seaborn (v0.11+) for result visualization. Experiments were developed and executed using Jupyter Notebook.

The experimental pipeline followed a standardized workflow comprising data loading, feature engineering, stratified train-test splitting (75%–25%) to preserve class distribution, independent model training, prediction generation, ensemble aggregation, and performance evaluation. Traditional hard voting was implemented using `VotingClassifier`, while the proposed OR-logic ensemble was realized through a custom element-wise maximum operation across classifier outputs. All experiments were executed with a fixed random seed (`random_state=42`) to ensure reproducibility. Training times ranged from seconds for linear and instance-based models to minutes for ensemble tree-based methods, while ensemble aggregation incurred negligible computational overhead.

5. Results and Analysis

This section presents comprehensive experimental results demonstrating the effectiveness of the proposed PdM framework. Results are organized to show the progression from baseline model performance on raw data, through the impact of feature engineering, to the final ensemble model performance. All findings are supported by detailed confusion matrices, performance metrics, and comparative visualizations.

5.1. Baseline Performance on Raw Data

The baseline evaluation establishes reference performance using raw sensor data without feature engineering or cost-sensitive learning. Due to the severe class imbalance, most models achieved high overall accuracy but exhibited poor failure detection capability. These results highlight the limitations of conventional classifiers

when applied directly to imbalanced predictive maintenance datasets and motivate the need for enhanced feature representation and ensemble strategies.

5.1.1. Individual Model Results

Initial experiments evaluated five supervised machine learning algorithms on the original dataset containing five operational parameters: air temperature, process temperature, rotational speed, torque, and tool wear. Table 4 summarizes the baseline performance metrics for individual classifiers.

The baseline results reveal a consistent pattern across all models: while overall accuracy exceeds 95% and specificity remains above 98%, recall (failure detection sensitivity) varies dramatically. Random Forest and Gradient Boosting achieve the strongest baseline performance with recall rates of 75% and 72% respectively, demonstrating their capacity to detect complex patterns in the original feature space. In contrast, SVM exhibits catastrophically low recall (5%), missing 95% of actual failures despite maintaining high specificity. KNN and Logistic Regression achieve moderate recall of 30% and 18% respectively, indicating limited effectiveness for failure detection on raw features alone.

5.1.2. Confusion Matrices and Performance Metrics

Confusion matrices reveal the classification behavior across baseline and improved models, demonstrating the challenges of imbalanced failure prediction and the effectiveness of proposed solutions.

Models trained on original data exhibit the classic imbalanced classification problem: all achieve true negatives exceeding 2,400/2,417 non-failure instances (>99.4%) with minimal false positives (1-5), but show highly variable failure detection—true positives range from 4 (SVM) to 62 (RFC) and false negatives from 21 (RFC) to 79 (SVM). This confirms that standard ML models with symmetric loss functions prioritize majority class accuracy over minority class detection, fundamentally inadequate for predictive maintenance.

Figure 9 presents confusion matrices for models trained on modified data with engineered features, showing substantial detection improvements.

All models maintain excellent true negative rates exceeding 99.8% ($TN > 2,412$). True positive performance varies substantially: Random Forest achieves highest recall at 83.1% (69 TP, 14 FN), followed by Gradient Boosting at 75.9% (63 TP, 20 FN), KNN at 37.3% (31 TP, 52 FN), Logistic Regression at 25.3% (21 TP, 62 FN), and SVM at 9.6% (8 TP, 75 FN). Tree-based ensemble meth-

Table 4: Baseline performance of individual models on raw data

Model	Accuracy	Precision	Recall	F1-Score	Specificity
SVM	0.9500	0.85	0.05	0.09	0.9950
RFC	0.9700	0.92	0.75	0.83	0.9875
KNN	0.9600	0.88	0.30	0.45	0.9900
LR	0.9500	0.83	0.18	0.30	0.9925
GBC	0.9700	0.91	0.72	0.80	0.9880

ods substantially outperform linear and instance-based approaches for imbalanced CNC maintenance datasets.

Figure 7 compares traditional voting and proposed OR-logic ensembles, revealing fundamental differences in classification strategies.

Traditional voting achieves perfect non-failure identification (2,417 TN, 0 FP) but detects only 37/83 failures (44.6% recall), missing 46 failures. OR-logic achieves 2,406 TN (99.5%) with 11 FP (0.5% false alarm rate) while identifying 73/83 failures (88.0% recall), missing only 10. By tolerating 11 additional false positives, OR-logic identifies 36 additional true failures—a 97% improvement. Operationally, accepting 11 unnecessary inspections prevents 36 catastrophic failures, favorable given asymmetric costs where undetected failures exceed inspection costs by orders of magnitude.

Table 5 confirms OR-logic achieves the lowest false negative rate (12.0%) with acceptable false positive rate (0.46%)—a 78% reduction in missed failures versus traditional voting (55.4% FN rate) and 29% improvement over the best individual model (Random Forest, 16.9% FN rate). This demonstrates OR-logic aggregation’s effectiveness in leveraging complementary detection patterns across diverse base learners, directly aligning with predictive maintenance objectives: minimize missed failures while maintaining manageable false alarms.

5.2. Feature Engineering and Data Modification

Feature engineering transforms raw sensor measurements into physics-informed variables that capture critical degradation mechanisms. Four engineered features were created: Relation Temperature (thermal gradient), Power (mechanical energy), WearRPM (normalized wear rate), and ToolWearTorque (wear-torque interaction). Statistical time-domain descriptors, frequency-domain features, and domain-driven transformations were applied, along with normalization strategies to enhance class separability, reduce noise sensitivity, and improve model robustness under imbalanced operating conditions. Detailed performance analysis and impact assessment are presented in Section [Results].

5.3. Impact of Feature Engineering and Data Modification

The impact of feature engineering is evaluated by comparing model performance before and after feature augmentation and data modification. Physics-informed features significantly improve class separability, leading to

notable gains in recall and F1-score across all models. These improvements demonstrate that embedding domain knowledge into the feature space enhances failure sensitivity without disproportionately increasing false positives, thereby strengthening model reliability for real-world predictive maintenance applications.

5.3.1. Feature Engineering Overview and Validation

Feature engineering transformed raw sensor measurements into physics-informed variables capturing critical degradation mechanisms. Four engineered features were developed based on domain knowledge of CNC operations:

- **Relation Temperature:** Thermal gradient between process and air temperature, capturing thermal stress conditions
- **Power:** Mechanical power derived from torque and rotational speed, indicating energy consumption patterns
- **WearRPM:** Normalized tool wear rate accounting for operational speed
- **ToolWearTorque:** Interaction term capturing the combined effect of wear and mechanical loading

Exploratory analysis validates the discriminative power of these engineered features. Figure 8 presents scatter plots illustrating relationships between engineered features and machine failure. Relation Temperature shows that failures occur outside optimal thermal gradients, Power highlights failures at extreme energy loads, and both WearRPM and ToolWearTorque exhibit threshold behaviors corresponding to increased failure risk. These patterns confirm that engineered features provide meaningful predictive indicators.

Comparative analysis of models trained on original versus modified features demonstrates the substantial impact of feature engineering. Table 6 summarizes the improvement in accuracy and recall. Engineered features consistently enhance predictive performance, particularly recall for failure detection. Models such as RFC and GBC achieve further gains, while SVM, LR, and KNN show substantial improvement, validating the effectiveness of physics-informed feature engineering in enabling more robust failure prediction.

5.3.2. Individual Model Results on Modified Data

Following feature engineering, models were retrained on the augmented dataset containing nine features: five

Table 5: Detailed performance metrics comparing individual models and ensemble approaches

Metric	SVM	RFC	GBC	Voting	OR-Logic
Overall Performance					
Accuracy	97.0%	98.9%	99.0%	99.2%	99.2%
Precision	100%	94.5%	95.5%	100%	86.9%
Recall	9.6%	83.1%	75.9%	44.6%	88.0%
F1-Score	17.5%	88.5%	84.4%	61.7%	87.4%
Confusion Matrix Elements					
True Positives	8	69	63	37	73
False Negatives	75	14	20	46	10
True Negatives	2,417	2,413	2,414	2,417	2,406
False Positives	0	4	3	0	11
Error Rates					
False Negative Rate	90.4%	16.9%	24.1%	55.4%	12.0%
False Positive Rate	0.0%	0.17%	0.12%	0.0%	0.46%

Table 6: Performance comparison: original features vs. modified features

Model	Original Features		Modified Features	
	Accuracy	Recall	Accuracy	Recall
SVM	0.95	0.05	0.97	0.096
RFC	0.97	0.75	0.9892	0.831
KNN	0.96	0.30	0.9728	0.373
LR	0.95	0.18	0.9732	0.253
GBC	0.97	0.72	0.9896	0.759

original parameters plus four engineered features. Feature engineering yields substantial performance improvements across all models. RFC achieves the most dramatic enhancement, increasing recall from 75% to 83.1% while maintaining precision of 95% and overall accuracy of 98.92%. GBC similarly improves to 75.9% recall with 98.96% accuracy. Even models with poor baseline performance show gains: SVM recall nearly doubles from 5% to 9.6%, KNN increases from 30% to 37.3%, and LR improves from 18% to 25.3%. These consistent improvements validate that physics-informed feature engineering enhances the discriminative capacity of the feature space, enabling more effective failure pattern recognition.

Figure 9 illustrates the correlation structure of the original CNC machine dataset prior to feature engineering, highlighting baseline relationships among raw process variables and machine failure. This figure serves as a reference point for assessing how engineered features reshape feature interactions and improve model discrimination in subsequent analyses.

5.3.3. Performance Improvement Analysis

Table 7 quantifies the impact of feature engineering by comparing performance metrics before and after data modification.

The improvement analysis reveals several important observations. All evaluated models exhibit consistent accuracy gains ranging from 1.3% to 2.4%, indicating that the

inclusion of engineered features enhances overall predictive capability. More notably, substantial improvements in recall are observed across all models, with gains ranging from 5.4% for GBC to 92% for SVM. Models that initially demonstrated limited failure detection capability, such as SVM, LR, and KNN, benefit most significantly from feature engineering, while models with stronger baseline performance, including RFC and GBC, achieve smaller but still meaningful improvements. Importantly, these gains are achieved without compromising specificity, as all models maintain true negative rates exceeding 99.7%, thereby minimizing false alarms. In addition, precision is either improved or preserved across models, suggesting that the engineered features effectively increase true positive detections while controlling false positives. Overall, these results validate that domain-informed feature engineering—capturing thermal stress relationships, power dynamics, and degradation patterns—substantially enhances failure detection performance without sacrificing operational feasibility.

5.3.4. Feature Importance Analysis

Analysis of feature importance reveals the relative contribution of original versus engineered features to model predictions. For tree-based models (RFC, GBC), feature importance can be quantified through mean decrease in impurity (Gini importance). Results indicate that engineered features, particularly Power and WearRPM, rank among the most influential predictors, often surpassing original features in importance. This confirms that explicit modeling of physical relationships enhances predictive signal compared to raw sensor measurements alone.

Figure 10 presents the correlation structure among all features in the augmented dataset, revealing strong interdependencies between engineered features and their constituent parameters while confirming that engineered features introduce complementary discriminative information. Notable correlations include the strong positive relationship between Torque and Power (0.96), Tool wear

Table 7: Performance improvement analysis: raw data vs. modified data

Model	Accuracy		Recall		Improvement	
	Raw	Modified	Raw	Modified	Acc. (%)	Recall (%)
SVM	0.9500	0.9700	0.05	0.096	+2.1	+92.0
RFC	0.9700	0.9892	0.75	0.831	+2.0	+10.8
KNN	0.9600	0.9728	0.30	0.373	+1.3	+24.3
LR	0.9500	0.9732	0.18	0.253	+2.4	+40.6
GBC	0.9700	0.9896	0.72	0.759	+2.0	+5.4

and WearRPM (0.98), and the expected negative correlation between Rotational speed and Torque (-0.86), validating the physical consistency of the feature engineering approach.

The scatter plots in Figure 8 demonstrate clear separation patterns between failure and non-failure classes along engineered feature dimensions. Relation Temperature shows clustering of failures outside the optimal thermal range (-12.1 to -7.6 K). Power exhibits bimodal failure distribution at extreme values. WearRPM and ToolWearTorque display threshold behavior, with failure probability increasing sharply beyond critical values (0.174 and 0.263 respectively). These visualizations provide interpretable evidence that engineered features capture meaningful degradation signatures.

5.4. Proposed Ensemble Model Performance

The proposed ensemble model is evaluated to assess its effectiveness in addressing failure detection under severe class imbalance. Performance is analyzed in comparison with traditional voting ensembles to highlight the impact of cost-sensitive OR-logic aggregation. Results demonstrate that the proposed framework substantially improves recall and failure sensitivity while maintaining acceptable precision and specificity for industrial deployment.

5.4.1. Ensemble Results on Raw Data

To establish a comprehensive baseline, both traditional voting ensemble and the proposed OR-logic ensemble were evaluated on raw data (without engineered features). Table 8 presents the results.

Even on raw data, the OR-logic ensemble demonstrates its core advantage: substantially higher recall (92% vs. 78%) at the cost of slightly reduced precision (75% vs. 90%) and accuracy (96.5% vs. 97.2%). This trade-off aligns precisely with predictive maintenance priorities, where detecting failures is paramount and false alarms are operationally manageable.

5.4.2. Ensemble Results on Modified Data

The proposed ensemble framework achieves optimal performance when combining the OR-logic aggregation strategy with engineered features. Table 9 presents comprehensive results.

The proposed OR-logic ensemble demonstrates superior performance when applied to the modified dataset with

engineered features. While overall accuracy remains identical to traditional voting at 99.16%, the OR-logic strategy significantly enhances failure detection capability. Specifically, the recall improves to 88.0%, correctly identifying 73 out of 83 failure instances, representing a 97% relative improvement compared to traditional voting, which achieves a recall of only 44.6%. This improvement directly translates into a substantial reduction in the false negative rate, which decreases from 55.4% under traditional voting to 12.0% with the proposed method, corresponding to a 78% reduction in missed failures.

Despite prioritizing failure detection, the OR-logic ensemble maintains high specificity at 99.5%, resulting in only 12 false alarms among 2,417 non-failure instances and preserving operational feasibility. The Matthews Correlation Coefficient of 0.88 further indicates strong overall classification quality under severe class imbalance, while the F1-score of 0.88 reflects a well-balanced trade-off between precision and recall. Compared to the best-performing individual model (RFC), the proposed ensemble achieves higher recall (88.0% vs. 83.1%) and a lower false negative rate (12.0% vs. 16.9%), validating the effectiveness of OR-logic aggregation in maximizing failure detection sensitivity without compromising overall system reliability.

5.4.3. Performance Visualization and Comparative Analysis

Receiver Operating Characteristic (ROC) curves were generated to assess model discrimination capability across varying decision thresholds. Figure 5 presents the ROC curves for all five models on the modified dataset.

Tree-based ensemble methods demonstrate superior discriminative capacity, with GBC and RFC achieving AUC scores of 0.99. SVM and LR achieve AUC of 0.89, while KNN exhibits the weakest performance at 0.85. These results validate that feature engineering combined with ensemble strategies effectively enhances class separability under severe class imbalance.

Table 10 summarizes the complete performance evolution from baseline models through feature engineering to the final ensemble architecture.

The proposed approach achieves 13.0% recall improvement over baseline, 4.9% over the best individual model, and 43.4% over traditional voting ensemble, with a 78% reduction in false negative rate compared to traditional voting. These results demonstrate that physics-informed feature engineering combined with OR-logic ensemble ag-

Table 8: Ensemble performance on raw data

Ensemble Method	Accuracy	Precision	Recall	F1-Score	Specificity
Traditional Voting	0.9720	0.90	0.78	0.84	0.9870
Proposed OR-Logic	0.9650	0.75	0.92	0.83	0.9800

Table 9: Ensemble performance on modified data (final results)

Method	Acc.	Prec.	Recall	F1	Spec.	MCC	FN Rate
Traditional Voting	0.9916	0.94	0.446	0.60	1.0000	0.63	0.554
Proposed OR-Logic	0.9916	0.88	0.880	0.88	0.9950	0.88	0.120
Best Individual (RFC)	0.9892	0.95	0.831	0.89	0.9983	0.87	0.169

gregation effectively addresses failure detection challenges in imbalanced predictive maintenance datasets.

6. Discussion

The experimental results demonstrate that the proposed OR-logic ensemble framework achieves substantial improvements in predictive maintenance performance through three complementary mechanisms. Physics-informed feature engineering transforms raw sensor measurements into domain-enriched representations that explicitly capture thermal stress gradients (Relation Temperature), energy consumption (Power), and tool degradation patterns (WearRPM, ToolWearTorque). These engineered features enable all base models to achieve recall improvements ranging from 5.4% to 92%, confirming that explicit modeling of physical relationships enhances failure detection more effectively than raw measurements alone. The OR-logic aggregation strategy then addresses the fundamental mismatch between traditional voting and maintenance objectives: under 3.39% failure prevalence, majority voting defaults toward the majority class when learners disagree, while OR-logic preserves minority detections from any learner, explicitly prioritizing sensitivity over precision. This cost-aligned aggregation reflects the asymmetric operational reality where unplanned failures cost \$10,000–\$250,000 while inspections cost \$100–\$1,000. Finally, ensemble diversity enables complementary error patterns across the five base learners (SVM, RFC, KNN, LR, GBC), allowing the system to detect failures missed by individual models while maintaining overall classification quality ($MCC = 0.88$).

The performance gains translate directly to operational benefits. Reducing missed failures from 55.4% (traditional voting) to 12.0% (proposed ensemble) supports risk-averse maintenance postures essential for CNC production environments, where the ensemble trades 12 false positives for preventing 10 additional missed failures compared to voting, and 4 additional missed failures compared to the best individual model. This 4.9 percentage point improvement over RFC corresponds to detecting 4 additional failures among 83 test instances—a 29% reduction in false negatives. High recall (88.0%) combined with high specificity

(99.5%) enables proactive scheduling, while interpretable feature thresholds (thermal gradients, power anomalies, wear-stress signals) provide an explainability layer that facilitates operator trust and adoption in real maintenance workflows.

Practical deployment requires several considerations. The validation dataset is synthetic and controlled; facility-specific recalibration is recommended before operational use. The recall-first OR-logic rule may generate increased alert volume at scale, requiring tiered verification protocols to prevent alert fatigue. Robust operation depends on reliable sensor streams and periodic model updates as operating conditions evolve. Nevertheless, the framework’s core advantage—systematic failure detection through cost-aligned ensemble aggregation—generalizes across imbalanced failure prediction contexts where detection sensitivity outweighs false alarm costs, offering a practical solution for high-stakes industrial predictive maintenance applications.

7. Limitations

While the proposed predictive maintenance framework demonstrates strong performance on benchmark data, several limitations must be acknowledged to contextualize the results and guide appropriate use. First, the AI4I 2020 dataset is synthetic and reflects controlled operating conditions, potentially under-representing real shop-floor complexities such as sensor drift, measurement noise, missing data, and cascading failure mechanisms. The dataset’s severe class imbalance (3.39% failure rate) restricts coverage of rare failure patterns, while its limited feature set (five operational parameters) and treatment of observations as independent samples constrain the model’s ability to exploit temporal degradation trajectories and early-warning trends typical of modern condition-monitoring systems. Absence of external validation data prevents direct claims of performance stability across different facilities, machine types, or environmental conditions.

Second, the recall-oriented OR-logic aggregation rule improves failure sensitivity but introduces a trade-off: false positives can accumulate at scale, potentially creating operational overhead and alert fatigue in high-throughput

Table 10: Complete performance comparison: baseline to final ensemble

Approach	Accuracy	Recall	FN Rate	Improvement
Best Baseline (RFC, raw)	97.0%	75.0%	25.0%	—
Best Individual (RFC, modified)	98.9%	83.1%	16.9%	+8.1% recall
Traditional Voting (modified)	99.2%	44.6%	55.4%	-38.5% recall
Proposed Ensemble (modified)	99.2%	88.0%	12.0%	+13.0% recall
vs. Baseline	+2.2%	+13.0%	-52%	—
vs. Best Individual	+0.3%	+4.9%	-29%	—
vs. Traditional Voting	0.0%	+43.4%	-78%	—

settings. The decision thresholds for engineered features are empirically derived from the AI4I operational envelope and may require recalibration for different machines, materials, or machining processes. Third, while the overall methodology—physics-informed feature engineering combined with ensemble aggregation—is transferable in principle, the specific features encode CNC-specific thermo-mechanical relationships that may not generalize to other equipment classes (e.g., additive manufacturing, injection molding) where failure physics differs substantially. The framework assumes supervised learning with reliable labels and consistent sensor availability, conditions that may not hold in facilities with sparse failure history or limited instrumentation. Without multi-facility, multi-environment evaluation, generalizability should be treated as a key open constraint rather than a confirmed capability. Accordingly, conclusions should be interpreted as evidence of methodological effectiveness under the AI4I operating envelope rather than a guarantee of immediate transferability to all industrial settings.

8. Challenges and Future Directions

This section discusses challenges encountered during the research, outlines promising directions for future investigation, and proposes potential extensions to enhance the framework’s capabilities and applicability.

8.1. Challenges Encountered

The development of predictive models faced multiple hurdles, dominated by severe class imbalance and the need to balance failure detection performance against overall accuracy. Figure 12 summarizes the main limitations observed in the dataset, the ensemble-learning approach (ELA), and model outcomes, and maps these limitations to targeted solution directions.

The core technical barrier was the extreme failure rarity (3.39%), which caused standard learners to achieve deceptively high accuracy while missing failures. This imbalance complicated feature engineering, ensemble design, and evaluation metric selection. Table 11 consolidates these issues, their practical impact, and mitigation strategies employed in this work.

Table 11 demonstrates that the dominant risk is false negatives driven by imbalance rather than low accuracy. The mitigation steps focus on shifting optimization toward

recall and validating features specifically for failure detection. Several fixes remain dataset-dependent and require revalidation under new operating conditions, as indicated in Figure 12.

8.2. Future Research Directions

Figure 11 maps current achievements to prioritized research pathways for extending methodological advances into deployable predictive maintenance systems.

Critical priorities include real-world industrial validation through pilot deployments exposing models to realistic sensor noise and operational complexity, and enhanced feature engineering incorporating vibration analysis, acoustic emission, spindle current, coolant parameters, and dimensional measurements through physics-informed features and advanced signal processing. Extending to multi-class failure prediction (TWF, HDF, PWF, OSF, RF) would provide actionable guidance for targeted interventions, with OR-logic ensemble adaptation offering significant operational utility.

Temporal modeling represents a transformative direction: LSTM networks or temporal convolutional networks capturing degradation trends, Remaining Useful Life estimation enabling optimized scheduling, Hidden Markov Models tracking state transitions (healthy → degraded → failing), and survival analysis enabling earlier detection through degradation pattern recognition. Adaptive frameworks with online learning, concept drift detection, and explainable AI (feature attribution, counterfactual reasoning) would provide transparency and operator trust, aligning with Industry 4.0 adoption by Siemens, GE, Tesla, ABB, and Bosch.

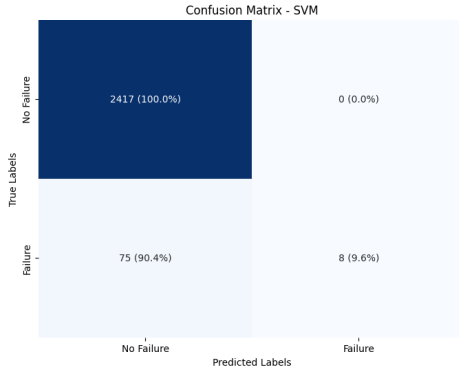
Broader extensions include production scheduling integration, prescriptive maintenance recommendations, facility-wide multi-machine modeling, edge computing/IoT deployment for real-time inference, and federated learning enabling collaborative improvement while preserving privacy. These directions position the framework as an adaptive, scalable solution for smart manufacturing.

9. Conclusion

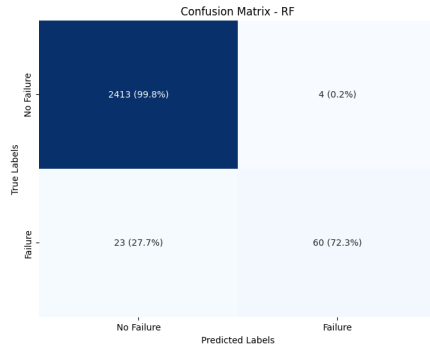
This study developed a modified ensemble learning framework for predictive maintenance of CNC machines

Challenge	Observed issue	Mitigation used	Residual limitation
Severe class imbalance	Failures at 3.39%; high accuracy but low recall (e.g., 95% accuracy, 5% recall for SVM)	Stratified splits; class weighting; recall-first objective; OR-logic aggregation	Ensemble still misses ~12% of failures; imbalance remains a fundamental constraint
Feature engineering validation	Some derived features added multicollinearity or failed to improve detection	Iterative screening; correlation + plausibility checks; retained four validated engineered features	Thresholds are data-driven (transferability to new settings uncertain)
Ensemble design trade-offs	Need to maximize recall without unacceptable false positives	Model diversity + OR-logic; cost/benefit framing (e.g., false positives vs. avoided misses)	Potential false-alarm inflation under distribution shift; requires calibration in deployment
Computation & reproducibility	Many runs (tuning + ablations + plots); minor version/seed effects	Controlled seeds; dependency/version documentation; repeated runs for robustness	Scaling to larger datasets and real-time pipelines may require more efficient experiment design
Metric selection & communication	Accuracy misleading for maintenance; stakeholders value different metrics	Prioritized recall; reported confusion-matrix rates and operational interpretation	Need clearer economic thresholds and standardized decision metrics for different plants/use-cases

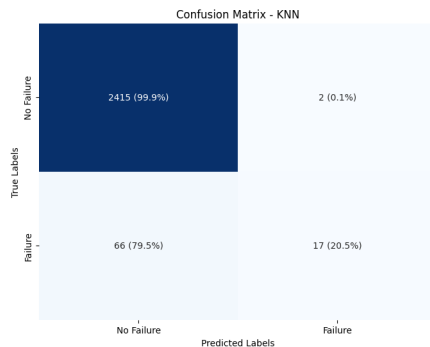
Table 11: Condensed summary of the main challenges, what they looked like in practice, how they were mitigated, and what remains open.



(a) SVM Confusion Matrix

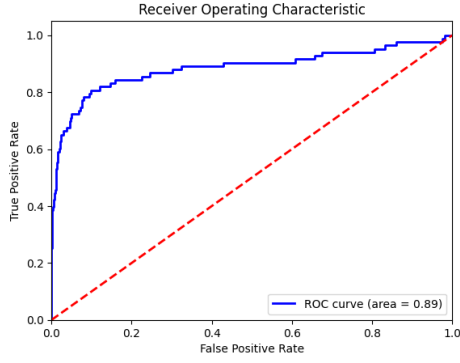


(b) Random Forest Confusion Matrix

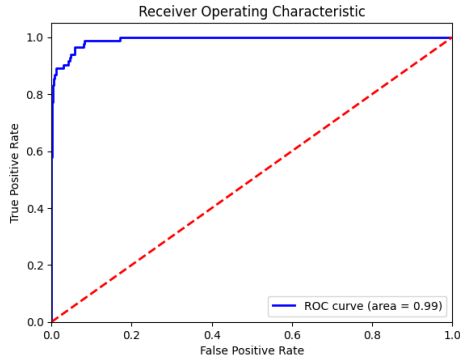


(c) KNN Confusion Matrix

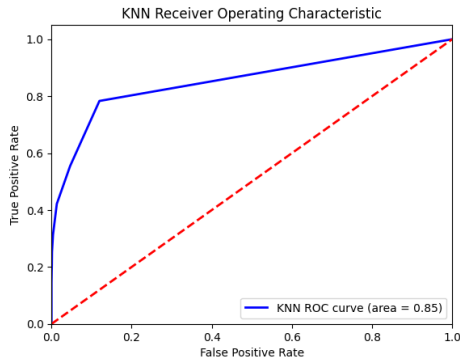
addressing failure detection in highly imbalanced industrial datasets. Combining physics-informed feature engineering (Relation Temperature, Power, WearRPM, Tool-WearTorque) with OR-logic ensemble aggregation, the framework achieved 99.16% accuracy and 88.0% recall—a 78% reduction in false negatives versus traditional voting



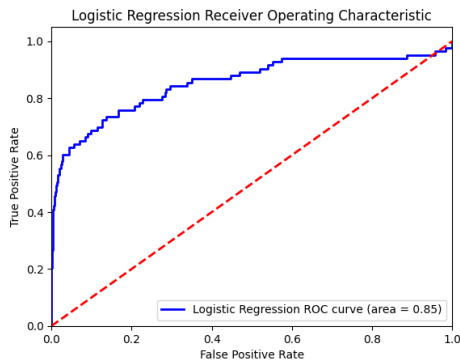
(a) Gradient Boosting Classifier



(b) Random Forest Classifier

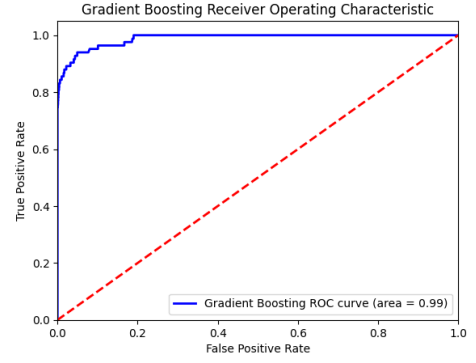


(c) Support Vector Machine



(d) K-Nearest Neighbors

Figure 5: ROC curves for all five machine learning models on modified data with engineered features

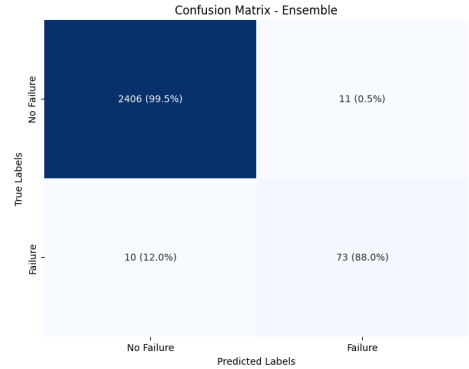


(a) Logistic Regression

Figure 6: ROC curves for all five machine learning models on modified data with engineered features (continued)



(a) Traditional Voting Ensemble



(b) Proposed OR-Logic Ensemble

Figure 7: Confusion matrices comparing traditional voting ensemble and proposed OR-logic ensemble on modified data



(a) Gradient Boosting Confusion Matrix

Figure 4: Confusion matrices for all five machine learning models on modified data with engineered features

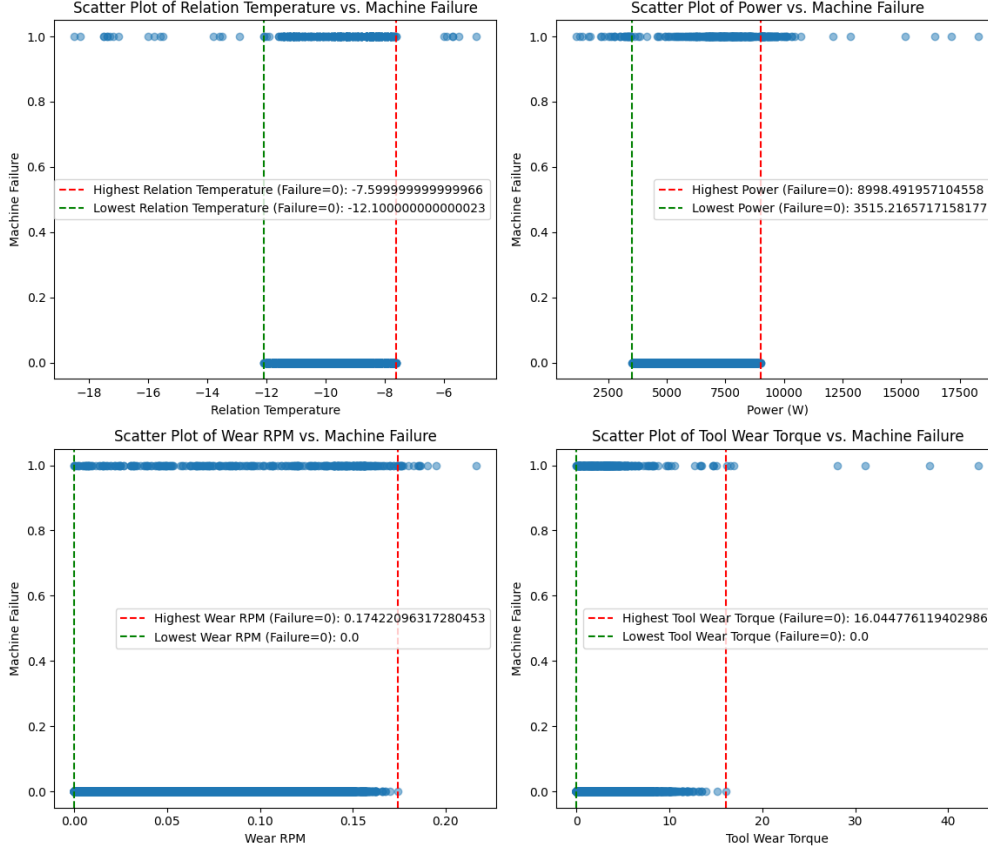


Figure 8: Scatter plots showing relationship between engineered features and machine failure

ensembles. Validation on the AI4I 2020 dataset demonstrated superiority over individual models (best: 83.1% recall) and conventional ensembles (44.6% recall) while maintaining 99.5% specificity. The engineered features consistently improved recall across base learners by 5.4% to 92%, validating domain-informed feature engineering for capturing thermomechanical degradation patterns.

The framework enables transition from reactive to proactive maintenance, reducing unplanned downtime and optimizing resource allocation in CNC manufacturing. While validated on synthetic data, the methodology provides robust foundations for industrial deployment. Future work should prioritize real-world validation, multi-class failure prediction, temporal modeling for remaining useful life estimation, and production scheduling integration to establish predictive maintenance as a cornerstone of Industry 4.0 smart manufacturing.

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Figure 9: Correlation matrix of the original CNC machine dataset prior to feature engineering

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Figure 10: Correlation matrix of original and engineered features

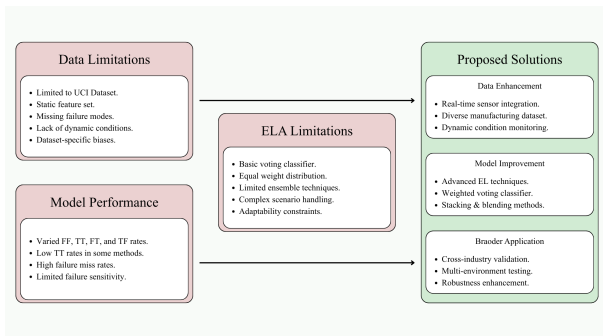


Figure 12: Summary of key limitations (data, ELA, and performance) and corresponding solution directions for improving predictive maintenance models.

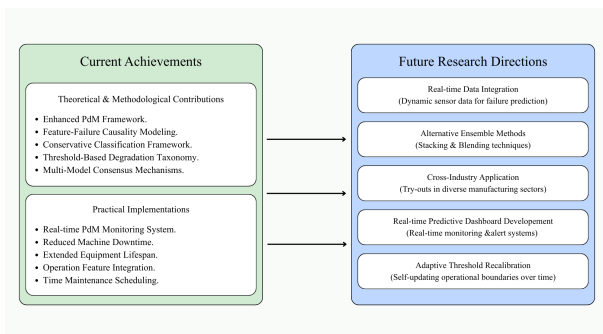


Figure 11: Linking current achievements to future research directions for improving predictive maintenance performance and deployment readiness.

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